

Court FX — Programmable LED Sport Courts

Turn one slab of concrete into a hundred different courts.

What It Is

Court FX installs and rents programmable LED sport flooring — interactive panels that sit on top of (or replace) a normal court surface and can change colors, lines, logos, and game layouts in an instant. One tap turns a gritty street court into a glowing arena, or swaps a basketball layout for pickleball, futsal, or a kids' light-up game. You sell the "wow factor" no rec center, gym, or event venue in your city currently has.

How It Makes Money

Three stacked revenue streams. (1) **Install sales** to gyms, schools, sports bars, trampoline parks, and developers who want a permanent showpiece court. (2) **Event rentals** — weddings, corporate parties, brand activations, and tournaments pay \$1,500–\$6,000 for a weekend of glowing floor. (3) **Recurring revenue** from your own pay-to-play sessions and from software/maintenance contracts. Buyers are facility owners chasing memberships and event planners chasing Instagram moments.

Startup Costs

- Interactive LED court tiles (sourced from Alibaba, Shenzhen suppliers): **\$45–\$90 per sq ft** delivered. A half-court demo (~1,500 sq ft) ≈ **\$70,000–\$110,000**. Start smaller with a **20x20 ft modular pad** ≈ **\$18,000–\$30,000**.
- Controller PC, software license, and content templates: **\$2,000–\$5,000**.
- Cargo trailer + ramps + dollies for the rental rig: **\$6,000–\$12,000**.
- Insurance (general liability, event rider): **\$1,500–\$3,000/yr**.
- LLC, website with booking, demo reel video: **\$1,500–\$3,000**.
- **Lean start (rental-only demo pad):** ~\$30,000–\$45,000.

The Numbers

Per-unit import cost on a 20x20 pad (400 sq ft) at ~\$55/sq ft ≈ **\$22,000 landed**. A single permanent install of that size sells for **\$60,000–\$95,000** → **\$38,000–\$70,000 gross per install**. On the rental side, one weekend event nets **\$2,500** against ~~\$400 of labor/transport~~ = ****\$2,100 profit/event****. A realistic month with 1 small install plus 3 weekend rentals: **\$40,000+ revenue, \$25,000–\$30,000 profit** once the gear is paid off. Even pure rentals (6–8 events/month) clear **\$10,000–\$16,000/month**.

How To Start

1. Order one 20x20 modular interactive LED pad from a vetted Alibaba supplier (ask for the "interactive LED dance floor / sport floor" with load-rated tiles and a 1-year warranty).
2. While it ships, film a sizzle reel using the supplier's existing footage and build a one-page booking site.
3. Set up the pad in your garage/warehouse and shoot your own demo content — color sweeps, court swaps, a logo reveal.
4. List on Peerspace, The Bash, and GigSalad as a premium event rental; DM every event planner and trampoline park in a 50-mile radius.

5. Land your first 2–3 rentals to generate real social proof and recoup cash.
6. Pitch one anchor permanent install (a gym, church gym, or sports bar) using the rental footage as proof.
7. Reinvest install profit into a second, larger pad and hire a 2-person setup crew.

Where To Get Customers

Instagram and TikTok (the floor IS the content), Peerspace/Splacer for event rentals, direct B2B outreach to gyms, schools, churches, breweries with patios, and real-estate developers. Partner with DJ/AV companies and tournament organizers for referral splits.

Pro Tips

- Lead with rentals, not installs. Rentals fund your demo inventory and generate the viral clips that close five-figure install deals.
- Spec load-rated, IP-graded tiles only — cheap dance-floor panels crack under running athletes and kill your reputation.
- Sell the *software*, not the floor: charge facilities a monthly fee for new game modes and seasonal themes so the court "never gets old," creating sticky recurring income.